

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1611

By Hicks G

A RESOLUTION to recognize Hawkins County Sheriff Ronnie Lawson on the occasion of his retirement.

WHEREAS, it is appropriate that the members of this General Assembly should honor those citizens who have performed with uncommon devotion and enthusiasm throughout their careers in law enforcement; and

WHEREAS, one such estimable individual is Hawkins County Sheriff Ronnie Lawson, who has devoted his life to the preservation of law and order and the protection of his fellow citizens; and

WHEREAS, after a distinguished career in law enforcement spanning several decades, Sheriff Lawson will take a much-deserved retirement as Hawkins County Sheriff in August 2026; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Lawson began his law enforcement career in 1977 as a patrolman with the Rogersville Police Department and, through his diligence and ability, rose through the ranks, becoming the department's first detective in 1989; and

WHEREAS, in 1990, he accepted the position of Chief Deputy for then Sheriff Wayne Clevinger; during his tenure in that role, he also served two years, part-time, as Chief of Police for the Town of Bulls Gap; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Ronnie Lawson has been instrumental in the development and advancement of specialized law enforcement units in Hawkins County, including the organization of the Sheriff's Office Tactical Unit in 1991 and the Sheriff's Office Aviation Unit in 1996, which provided critical support in law enforcement operations throughout the region; and

WHEREAS, under former Sheriff Warren Rimer, Ronnie Lawson served as Chief Detective and later in the Patrol Division before being elected Sheriff of Hawkins County in 2010; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Lawson's many responsibilities in office include overseeing all aspects of law enforcement in Hawkins County, including the administration of the county jail, the supervision of sworn officers and correctional staff, and the protection of more than 60,000 citizens across nearly 500 square miles; and

WHEREAS, a dedicated member of his profession and an active member of his community, Sheriff Lawson serves on the Board of Directors for Hawkins County Emergency Services and the 911 Central Dispatch Center and is a member of the Tennessee Sheriffs' Association, the Rogersville Shrine Club, and the Fraternal Order of Police – Burgess Mills Post; and

WHEREAS, Sheriff Ronnie Lawson exemplifies the spirit and allegiance to family and community that are characteristic of a true Tennessean; and

WHEREAS, throughout his estimable career, Sheriff Lawson has demonstrated the utmost professionalism, ability, and integrity, winning the sincere respect and admiration of his fellow officers and the citizens of Hawkins County; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend Hawkins County Sheriff Ronnie Lawson on his exemplary career and extend to him our best wishes for much continued success and happiness during his retirement.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.